condition that his job would last only till a suitable European was found for the job did not deter him.

There was consternation in his family at his decision to give up a secure position in a leading foreign bank for the uncertainty of a new venture. The fact that a Mr Bruce who was the accountant of the Chartered Bank would be joining the new bank as a Manager helped to allay some of their fears and they finally relented. Mr Bruce never made it to the Bank of India and the burden of organizing the office fell on Sorabji. He proved equal to the task as he cultivated direct relations with merchants and came to know their problems and understood their business. The good work did not go unnoticed: Sorabji was complimented by the auditors of the bank and the Directors of the bank also placed on record their appreciation of Sorabji's work, lauding his industry and acumen which had laid sound foundations of the bank in a short period of time.

However, the acknowledgement of Sorabji's contribution did not prevent them from appointing H.P. Stringfellow as the Manager on a huge salary of ₹5,000 per month. This figure emphasizes the huge chasm that separated the higher rungs of the hierarchy manned by Europeans and the lower rungs to which people like Sorabji and his brother were confined. Stringfellow, who came to the Bank in December 1906, had earlier been in the employ of the Alliance Bank of Simla Ltd.[4] This is also an indication of how deep-rooted the prejudice was, since even a bank sponsored by Indians took it for granted that the Manager could only be a European. A.J. Stewart who had worked with the Bank of Bombay was appointed as the Chief Accountant.

Stringfellow soon came to form a high opinion of Sorabji's abilities and did not hesitate to acknowledge the fact publicly. He inducted him as an interpreter in discussions with the bank's clients, most of whom could not speak English. Sorabji was almost always in attendance on the Manager and his prestige in the bank and among its clients soared. This was not liked by the English accountant who resolved to put Sorabji in his place. A series of orders whose only purpose was to humiliate him culminated in a European being appointed as assistant accountant to whom Sorabji was asked to submit the vouchers that came to him. Protests against this affront fell on deaf ears: European superiority was an established fact and could not be challenged. After this incident Sorabji was convinced that a fair deal was possible only if the Indian sponsored banks were also managed by Indians.